

Creating Case Classification Sheets in NVivo

Video Tutorial Summary & Step-by-Step Implementation Guide

Overview: Case Classification Sheets in NVivo allow qualitative researchers to record demographic data and categorical attributes (e.g., Age, Gender, Role, Location) for units of analysis (Cases). This structure enables cross-tabulation and comparative analysis across participant groups.

1. CORE CONCEPTS & VOCABULARY

Cases The primary unit of analysis (e.g., individual interviewees, organizations, sites, or focus groups).	Case Classification A template that defines the demographic framework (e.g., "Person", "Organization", "School").
Attributes The specific variables measured for each case (e.g., Age Group, Gender, Qualification, Years of Experience).	Attribute Values The explicit data entries assigned to each case (e.g., "Female", "30–39", "Master's Degree").

2. STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE: CREATING A CLASSIFICATION SHEET

Follow these structured steps as outlined in the video tutorial to create and configure a case classification sheet manually inside NVivo:

- Create Case Classification:** Navigating to the Navigation View, right-click *Case Classifications* and select *New Classification*. Name it appropriately (e.g., Participant Demographic Data).
- Define Attributes:** Right-click the newly created classification in List View and select *New Attribute*. Specify the Attribute Name (e.g., Gender, Age Group) and Data Type (Text, Integer, Date, Boolean).
- Predefine Values:** In the Attribute Properties window under the *Values* tab, add the potential predefined values (e.g., Male, Female, Non-binary, Unassigned).
- Link Cases to Classification:** Go to the *Cases* folder, select all target cases, right-click, navigate to *Classification*, and choose your classification sheet.
- Open & Populate the Grid:** Double-click the classification sheet in List View to open the matrix grid. Select or type values directly for each case row.

3. METHODS FOR POPULATING CLASSIFICATION SHEETS

Depending on data volume and project setup, NVivo supports three primary methods for populating case attribute data:

METHOD	PROCEDURE	BEST SUITED FOR
1. Manual Entry	Opening the Classification Sheet grid and selecting values from dropdown menus or typing directly into cells.	Small qualitative studies (< 25 interview subjects).
2. Excel Import	Importing a prepared Excel spreadsheet (CSV/XLSX) matching participant names with columns for demographic attributes.	Medium-to-large studies with existing survey or demographic tables.
3. Autocode Assistant	Using NVivo's <i>Autocode Dataset Wizard</i> on imported survey responses or structured transcripts.	Qualtrics / SurveyMonkey datasets and structured interview series.

4. PRACTICAL APPLICATIONS & ANALYTICAL VALUE

Once your Case Classification Sheet is fully configured and populated, it unlocks advanced qualitative query options:

- **Crosstab Queries:** Compare coded themes against demographic attributes (e.g., comparing how *Female* vs. *Male* respondents speak about a specific topic).
- **Matrix Coding Queries:** Cross-reference coded text nodes with participant categories to detect subtle group variations.
- **Attribute-Based Filtering:** Filter data subsets during qualitative coding to focus exclusively on specific sub-populations (e.g., teachers with >10 years experience).
- **Data Visualization:** Generate summary charts and sunburst diagrams based on demographic distributions.

Pro Tip: Always set up your Case Classification Sheet early in your qualitative project before commencing extensive thematic coding. This ensures seamless attribute-driven querying throughout your analysis workflow.

